

# SCOUTING REPORT

Prepared by Tobias Galante — Football Scout | Technical Report

## PLAYER DATA

**Name:** Tyler Bindon  
**Age:** 20 years old (July 26, 2004)  
**Nationality:** New Zealand  
**Position:** Central Defender  
**Preferred foot:** [data not provided]  
**Current club:** Sheffield United (on loan from Nottingham Forest)  
**Background:** Path from East Coast Bays to LAFC, Reading, and Nottingham Forest (signed February 2025); 13 caps for New Zealand's senior team; featured at the Paris 2024 Olympics  
**Report date:** 12/08/2025



## EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Tyler Bindon's career reflects discipline, sporting heritage, and innate leadership. Born into a sports-oriented family — his mother Jenny Bindon was a goalkeeper for New Zealand's 'Football Ferns' and an Olympic athlete — his path to professional football has been driven by personal dedication, taking him from East Coast Bays to LAFC, Reading, and eventually Nottingham Forest, who signed him in February 2025 after he impressed in League One with Reading. He is currently gaining experience on loan at Sheffield United in the Championship, under his former coach Rubén Sellés.

## TECHNICAL ANALYSIS

His attributes include superior aerial dominance and exceptional game reading, with the ability to break lines through progressive passing and positioning. These traits, combined with calm decision-making, have earned him comparisons to Virgil van Dijk — a notable external benchmark for a centre-back still early in his career at senior level.

## TACTICAL ANALYSIS

Bindon shows elite tactical discipline, a quality reflected both in his club form and in his key defensive role for New Zealand at the Paris 2024 Olympic Games. His calm decision-making under pressure suggests a defender comfortable organising a back line rather than one who relies purely on physical duels.

## PHYSICAL AND MENTAL ASPECTS

A natural leader, Bindon made his international loyalty clear despite being eligible for both the United States and New Zealand — notably wearing New Zealand shin pads even while representing the US U-19 team. This commitment was rewarded with 13 caps for the senior 'All Whites' side and a key defensive role at the Paris 2024 Olympics, reflecting strong mental clarity and identity in his career decisions.

## KEY DATA POINTS

- 13 caps for New Zealand's senior national team ('All Whites').
- Key defensive role at the Paris 2024 Olympic Games.
- Signed by Nottingham Forest in February 2025 after standout form at Reading.
- Named 'Best Emerging Talent' at the Halberg Awards.

## STRENGTHS AND WEAKNESSES

### Strengths

- Exceptional game reading and ability to break lines.
- Dominance in aerial duels.
- A natural leader with elite tactical discipline.

### Areas for Improvement / Limitations

- [data not provided]

## PROJECTION AND CONCLUSION

After being named Best Emerging Talent at the prestigious Halberg Awards, Tyler Bindon is no longer just a prospect. At just 20 years old, and citing Rúben Dias as one of his idols, he is widely considered a cornerstone of New Zealand's next football generation, and his current loan spell at Sheffield United represents a key step toward establishing himself as a regular Championship or Premier League-level defender.